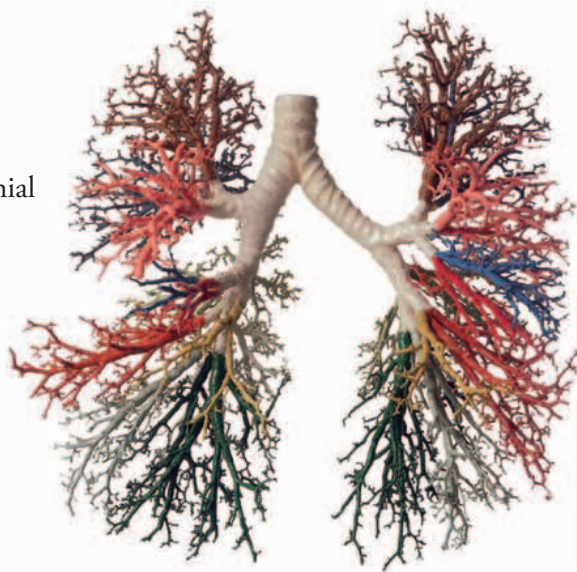


BRONCHIAL TREE

The branching network of airways inside the lungs is sometimes called the bronchial tree. As you can see here, it looks like an upside-down tree with the trachea as the trunk, bronchi as the branches, and the tiny bronchioles as twigs.

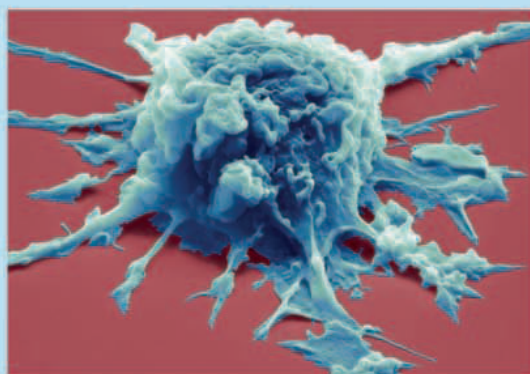


The left bronchus carries air to and from the left lung.

The left lung opened up to show its structure.

LOOK CLOSER: DUST GOBBLERS

When you breathe in air, most dust particles, pollen grains, and germs are trapped by sticky mucus in the nose and airways. But some of them travel deep into the lungs. Before they can do any harm, they are gobbled up by wandering macrophages.



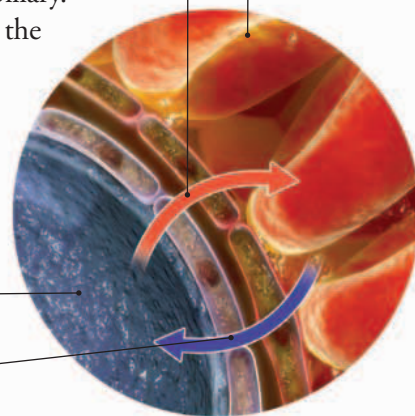
▲ **GERM EATER** A macrophage is a type of white blood cell. It moves by extending its narrow "arms," which it also uses to grab foreign particles.

INTO THE BLOOD

This is a close-up view of what happens at the junction between an alveolus and a capillary. Oxygen travels from the alveolus into the blood, and carbon dioxide moves in the opposite direction.

Oxygen passes into the blood.

Blood cell



Inside of alveolus

Carbon dioxide passes out of the blood into the alveolus.

The heart fits into this space.

Slippery membranes surround the lungs.